



Janani Ravi,
former Googler and
Stanford alumna with her son

“THINGS AREN'T GETTING EASIER FOR MOST CODERS”

Even though many new programming languages and frameworks have emerged lately, many developers still need a guide — either online or offline — to enhance their coding skills. **Janani Ravi**, a former Googler and Stanford alumna, closely observed this behaviour before co-founding an online content studio called Loonycorn. Launched in October 2015, the studio produces developer-focused online courses for platforms such as Pluralsight, StackSkills and Udemy. **Jagmeet Singh** of *OSFY* speaks with Ravi to understand the need for an enhanced training model for developers. Edited excerpts...

Q How did the idea to launch Loonycorn come about?

The seed of the idea came in 2013, when my husband and I were both working with Google in Singapore. We encountered a video by RSA (the Royal Society of Arts) about what motivates people to work. The video has over 10 million hits on YouTube. We were blown away by how vividly we were able to recall the video even years after we watched it. After that, we started experimenting with a video-making tool called Videoscribe, and then started to build its automated version. By 2015, we had built a preliminary version of a video auto-generation engine. We filed for a patent for it in the US as well as in India, but then we realised that we enjoyed making content more than building an engine to help others build content. So we quit our jobs and started working on building niche content full time. By doing this on a regular basis, our startup morphed from a tech startup into a content startup.

Q So what's different about Loonycorn when compared to the others in the market?

We are different in a good way because we are super-small with a team of eight members, have no external funding and are focused on just sitting down in one place for hours on end and doing work that we can be proud of. In about 18 months since we started Loonycorn, we have built about 100 courses and enrolled more than 100,000 students. We have also made lots of mistakes, but they were honest mistakes. I think we have largely avoided making the same mistake twice.